

A push for new Senate leader

Schumer faces calls to step down after some Democrats in caucus vote to end shutdown.

By MICHAEL WILNER, ANA CEBALLOS AND MELODY GUTIERREZ

WASHINGTON — Sen. Chuck Schumer of New York is facing mounting pressure to step aside as leader of the Senate Democratic caucus after eight members voted against his wishes Sunday, joining Republicans in a bid to end the longest government shutdown in history.

The vote was just the latest development in a troubling week for the 74-year-old Schumer, who, after eight years as the top Senate Democrat, has faced growing calls from within the party to make way for a new generation of leadership.

Elections last week revealed the emergence of a growing progressive movement in Schumer's hometown, where the longtime senator declined to endorse Zohran Mamdani in his successful bid for New York City mayor.

National progressive organizations urged him Monday to step down and have encouraged a popular congresswoman in the state, Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez, to run for his Senate seat in 2028. Polls show Schumer faces the lowest approval numbers of any national leader in Washington.

His leadership troubles come on the heels of Rep. Nancy Pelosi (D-San Francisco), the first female speaker of the House, announcing her retirement, a decision that generated praise across the political aisle last week reflecting on her shrewd ability to control a sprawling House Democratic caucus during high-stakes votes.

"Schumer is no longer effective and should be replaced," Rep. Ro Khanna [See [Schumer](#), A7]



J. SCOTT APPLEWHITE Associated Press



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SENATE Minority Leader Chuck Schumer (D-N.Y.), top, said the bill "fails to do anything of substance to fix America's healthcare crisis." Majority Leader John Thune (R-S.D.), above left, promised to hold a vote later on healthcare subsidies.

Shutdown deal advances as Democrats balk

Spending package would reopen government, ignore health costs

By ANA CEBALLOS AND MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — A deal that could end the longest government shutdown in U.S. history is poised to head to the House, where Democrats are launching a last-ditch effort to block a spending agreement reached in the Senate that does not address healthcare costs.

The push comes as Speaker Mike Johnson (R-La.) urged House members on Monday to start making their way back to Washington in anticipation of the chamber voting on a spending package this week. The Senate began taking a series of votes Monday night, a day after Senate Republicans reached a deal with eight senators who caucus with Democrats.

The spending plan, which does not include an extension of the Affordable Care Act subsidies that are set to expire at the end of the year, has frustrated many Democrats who spent seven weeks pressuring Republicans to extend the tax cred-

its. It would, however, fund the government through January, reinstate federal workers who were laid off during the shutdown and ensure that federal employees who were furloughed receive back pay.

Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R-S.D.) also promised senators a vote in December that would put lawmakers on record on the healthcare subsidies. Thune said in a speech Monday that he was "grateful that the end is in sight" with the compromise.

"The American people have suffered long enough," he said. "Let's not pointlessly drag this bill out. Let's get it done, get it over to the House so we can get this government open."

Senate Democrats who defected have argued that a vote is the best deal they could get as the minority party, and that forcing vulnerable Republicans in the chamber to vote on the issue will help them win ahead of next year's midterm elections.

As the Senate prepared [See [Shutdown](#), A6]

LAPD failed to disclose abuse claims

Allegations against officers went unreported to state long after law passed

By LIBOR JANY

The Los Angeles Police Department took more than a year to begin fully disclosing domestic abuse allegations against officers after the state passed a law that mandates reporting and can trigger permanent bans from police work in California.

The revelation came out through testimony at an administrative hearing last month for a rookie LAPD officer who was fired after the department alleged she

committed time card fraud and physically assaulted her former romantic partner, a fellow officer.

A sergeant from the LAPD's serious misconduct unit testified in a proceeding against Tawny Ramirez, according to Ramirez's attorney and evidence from the closed-door hearing reviewed by The Times. The sergeant said the department did not start reporting certain domestic abuse cases to the state until after Ramirez was terminated in early February 2024. That is more than a year after rules

took effect requiring the LAPD and other police agencies to promptly report officers accused of "serious misconduct" to the state's police accreditation body, which grants authorization to work in law enforcement.

Senate Bill 2, passed in 2021, made domestic violence one of the nine categories of "serious misconduct" — including excessive force, dishonesty, sexual assault and acts of bias on the basis of factors including race, sexual orientation and gender — that police agencies are obligated to report

to the state's Commission on Police Officer Standards and Training, or POST.

The LAPD sergeant testified that the reporting practices were based on guidance from POST's former compliance director, who said at a training session that agencies did not have to "report first-time misdemeanor domestic violence," according to Ramirez's attorney Nicole Castronovo and the hearing evidence reviewed by The Times.

Ramirez appealed the basis for her firing and has [See [LAPD](#), A6]

A fight to keep the Bruins in Pasadena

Rose Bowl asks court to block UCLA from moving its football games amid lawsuit.

By BEN BOLCH

The city of Pasadena and the Rose Bowl Operating Co. on Monday sought a preliminary injunction and temporary restraining order seeking to prevent UCLA from leaving the Rose Bowl or terminating its stadium lease until pending litigation against the school is resolved.

The filing contends that the plaintiffs would suffer "immediate and irreparable harm if the status quo is not preserved" while the suit plays out. A hearing has been scheduled for Wednesday in Los Angeles County Superior Court.

Last week, the plaintiffs sued to force the Bruins to honor the terms of the lease that requires them to stay at the Rose Bowl through the end of the 2043 season.

UCLA responded in a statement that it was evaluating options for its football home, though a person familiar with the university's thinking told The Times that if the Bruins decided to leave for SoFi Stadium, they would want to do so for the 2026 season.

UCLA did not immediately respond to a request for comment regarding the newest legal development. A representative from SoFi Stadium declined to comment.

Money is clearly at the heart of UCLA's proposed move.

For fiscal year 2024, the latest for which data have been released, UCLA reported \$8.35 million in football ticket sales — less than half of the \$20 million it made in 2014, when it was setting attendance records.

As part of any lease agreement with SoFi, the Bruins would receive suite revenue; at the Rose Bowl, the Bruins' contract gives them no return on suite sales or stadium sponsorship sales and only a sliver of [See [Rose Bowl](#), A11]

Five guilty in MS-13 mountain murders

By MATTHEW ORMSETH

The young men from MS-13 lived mostly in the cramped urban districts of Van Nuys, Panorama City and North Hollywood.

But it was in the mountains north and west of Los Angeles where, as one alleged gang member put it in a recorded jailhouse sting, they went "to play."

At a remote helipad and scenic overlooks, many miles from any witnesses or good Samaritans who might intervene, the gangsters — some just teenagers — killed four people between 2017 and 2019, Deputy Dist. Atty. Eric Siddall told a jury last week in federal court. The five alleged MS-13 members on trial were also charged with

killing two people in Van Nuys and North Hollywood.

Also known as the Mara Salvatrucha, MS-13 was founded 40 years ago by Salvadoran immigrants in Los Angeles. It has since metastasized into an international criminal organization led by imprisoned gang members in Central America.

Over a two-month trial, prosecutors made the case that the local branches of the gang became far more violent around 2016. An influx of gangsters from Central America brought with them "the Salvadoran rules," which required prospective members to kill to prove their loyalty, said Siddall, who was deputized to assist in the federal racketeering prosecution.

[See [Guilty](#), A7]



MAYA ALLERUZZO For The Times

CHURCHES, which are a major tourist draw in Taybeh, West Bank, now see fewer visitors. Above, the Christ the Redeemer Latin Church.

Test of faith for this Palestinian Christian village

In Taybeh, West Bank, residents face fear and an uncertain future amid settler violence, Israeli roadblocks and economic woes.

By NABIH BULOS

TAYBEH, West Bank — "Come visit Taybeh," begins the brochure touting the tourist attractions here, the last entirely Palestinian Christian village in the Israeli-occupied West Bank.

Though it counts Jesus among its many visitors over the years, said Khaldoon Hanna, Taybeh's avuncular deputy mayor, these days "no one is coming."

He sighed as he looked around the restaurant he owns on the village's Main Street. It felt abandoned, with little trace

of activity in the kitchen and a layer of dust coating most tables. Only one faucet worked in the bathroom, but it didn't feel worth it to repair the rest.

"In the last two years, I haven't had more than 20 tourists come in here," Hanna said.

How could they, Hanna said, when you have to negotiate a growing gantlet of Israeli roadblocks just to get here? Or face off with emboldened settlers who make increasing forays into the village to burn cars or destroy property? In July they even tried to set fire to the ruins of the Church of St. George, a 4th century Byzantine structure on Taybeh's hilltop, Hanna and religious leaders said; the Israeli government says it's unclear what started the blaze.

"There's a vicious attack on us at this point, and we as Christians, we can do [See [West Bank](#), A4]

Same-sex marriage challenge fails

Supreme Court declines to revisit ruling as part of a dispute by a former Kentucky official. **NATION, A5**

A long delay in plutonium alert

Residents weren't told for months about test result at former Navy base. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Partly sunny.
L.A. Basin: 81/60. **B6**

Markets **A11**
Opinion Voices . **A12-13**

Norton Simon Museum turns 50

The Pasadena fine art institution renovates and reintroduces itself. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

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